WEB SUMMIT 2026 · TOKEN ACCOUNTANT · BRIEF 2 · 2026-11-05

Your agents' token use, 5 November

Your agents were busy today, but none of them reported their tokens. Asking them by message has not worked. One yes from you (A1) makes it part of every run.

70,242
Fresh tokens measured
Only mine, from yesterday's run. Nobody else reported.

3.2 million
Cache reads measured
Re-reading, also only mine.

1 of 11
Agents reporting
Ten agents ran today without reporting.

23
Commits, no report
By the four agents asked yesterday. The work happened, the numbers did not.

Who is measuring

✓ accountant: reports

conductor, dev, dashboard, designer: asked yesterday

messaging, factory, builder, ux, journalist, synthetic: asked today

Commits since brief 1 by the agents asked yesterday



All four: 0 ledger lines. Six newer agents were asked today; three run on Sonnet 5.5, a useful comparison once they report.

Ways to save

1. Start fresh more often
Still the biggest one from yesterday: synthetic's single long session re-read its history at every step.
About 173,000 tokens re-read per step.

2. Smaller model for helpers
Persona helpers on Sonnet 5.5 or Haiku 5.5 instead of Opus 5.5. Test first (A2).
111 helper steps, all Opus 5.5.

3. Make reporting automatic
Asking by message does not stick. A line in each agent's wake prompt does (A1).
23 runs by asked agents, 0 reports.

Your decisions (tick one each)

A1. Add the report step to every agent's wake prompt?
One line per prompt, added by your conductor. Without it, these briefs stay empty.

☐ **Yes, the conductor adds it to all (my pick)** ☐ Yes, I add it myself ☐ No

A2. Test cheaper models for the persona helpers before the next run?
One persona each on Sonnet 5.5 and Haiku 5.5, scored blind. Under 200,000 tokens, once.

☐ **Yes, test first (my pick)** ☐ No, keep Opus 5.5

A3. A fresh session for each conductor run?
Waits on three measured runs, so on A1.

☐ **Measure three runs, then decide (my pick)** ☐ Switch now ☐ Keep as is

Fresh tokens: new reading, writing and memory: the real work.
Cache reads: text the model already holds, read again; cheap one by one, costly in bulk.
Ledger line: one row of numbers an agent writes after each run.

Next: Brief 3 on 6 November at 17:30 UTC.
Numbers from: people/indi/accountant/ledger/ (the accountant file), people/indi/accountant/asks.md, git log since brief 1
By accountant@web-summit.indi